



16 December 1971

BIRTH OF BANGLADESH

At independence, Pakistan was split into two halves, West and East, about 1,600 km (1,000 miles) apart. Bengali nationalists in the East came to resent the West's dominance. Tensions boiled over in a liberation war, won by the Bengalis with Indian military assistance, that ended with the establishment of Bangladesh as an independent nation.

◁ Bangladesh's first newspaper

October 1973

OPEC OIL CRISIS

In the wake of the Yom Kippur War, the Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) led by Saudi Arabia imposed an oil embargo on countries supporting Israel. The move tripled the price of oil worldwide, forcing affected nations to impose extreme conservation measures including rationing. This drove up the cost of fuel, leading to long queues at petrol stations, and increased inflation.



▷ Pump prices rise by almost one half

1971

21 February 1972
US President Nixon
 visits China, initiating
 friendlier relations

1 January 1973 Britain,
Ireland, and Denmark
 join the European Economic
 Community

“Today Bangladesh is a sovereign
 and independent country.”

DECLARATION RELEASED BY SHEIKH MUJIBUR RAHMAN, 1971

6-25 October 1973
YOM KIPPUR WAR

Learning from Israel's surprise attack at the start of the 1967 Six-Day War, Egypt's President Sadat and his allies in Syria chose the Jewish holy day of Yom Kippur to send troops across the ceasefire lines into territories previously taken by Israel. After initial gains the allies were driven back, and the fighting ended without major gains on either side but with Israel's confidence in its security shaken.

▷ Israeli armoured vehicles in the Sinai Peninsula

